

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - September 15, 2026

Compiled summary for Tuesday, September 15, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio work after the September 12 Part 2 documentation state, verifying the United States Eastern date, refreshing the current project snapshot, extracting and studying all thirty-seven pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs, designing three About Dev page mockups, implementing the selected Builder Story direction at /aboutdev, wiring the landing-page profile photo to the new route, preserving local-only delivery expectations during the page work, resizing and centering the About Dev profile bubble through wide, restacked, narrow, and portrait views, matching the page navigation gap to the rest of the site, replacing draft belief-card language with the requested My Core Beliefs copy, transforming the belief system from rectangular cards into a circular proof-card formation with a transparent stroke-only center star, updating Featured Case Studies commit and worklog quantities, adding measured horizontal dividers between the PLATFORM and DEVICE rows on project cards, raising the landing proof worklog stat to 0.2k, clearing local development cache during the responsive tuning pass, validating TypeScript and static export health, restoring the Next.js dev route reference after the static build, documenting committed source state 076def6, and generating the September 15 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_september12_part2.pdf and after the September 12 Part 2 documentation state. The source state reviewed for this record is 076def6c932e852b6372c5043a302790aacf536a on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was generated, titled Refined landing case study proof details. The latest source commits in scope are 06c9cea Added About Dev page and portfolio proof updates, 9708a3b Refined About Dev core beliefs presentation, and 076def6 Refined landing case study proof details. No Hostinger deploy-branch work, production publish, or source commit/push was performed during this PDF-generation pass. The local documentation delta created before this PDF was the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file; this PDF is the new September 15 root-level documentation artifact.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date with TZ=America/New_York date from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio, which reported Tuesday, September 15, 2026 at 10:49 PM EDT with UTC offset -0400. The worklog therefore uses September 15, 2026, even though repository and external systems may already be near or past the UTC date boundary.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before writing this worklog, preserving the Portfolio convention that the current source snapshot is refreshed before session documentation.
- Reviewed the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt for the current source tree, public image and PDF inventories, package scripts, git context, recent commits, generated-cache policy, route structure, source dumps, and standing local workflow notes.
- Extracted and studied all thirty-seven pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext: the July 11, 14, 15 Part 1, 15 Part 2, 16, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30, and 31 records; the August 1 Parts 1-3, August 3, 4, 5, 6, 10 Parts 1-2, 11, 12 Parts 1-2, 14, 16, and 24 records; and the September 7, September 8, September 8 Part 2, September 9, September 11, September 12 Part 1, and September 12 Part 2 records.
- Compared the complete PDF series for title cadence, root-level filename conventions, same-day part suffixes, opening-summary density, source-material language, baseline and goal framing, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation wording, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, and output-artifact closure.
- Checked pdftinfo and pdffonts on the latest September 12 Part 2 baseline. The accepted output convention remains US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, an unencrypted document, and Codex author, creator, and producer metadata.

- Reviewed the September 15 commit history through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git status, git rev-parse, and git branch -vv. Confirmed main points at 076def6 and tracks origin/main before this documentation artifact was generated.
- Reviewed the current implementation files that carry the September 15 work: app/aboutdev/page.tsx, app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, app/page.tsx, app/globals.css, the About Dev mockup assets under mockups/, and the refreshed project snapshot.

Baseline Status Before September 15 Work

- The September 12 Part 2 state had removed Articles from the visible navbar while preserving the route, unified landing and Alla Vostra proof-stat typography, refined Alla Vostra UX Product Flow language, and enlarged the landing-page Martin Prahli tag.
- The portfolio did not yet have an About Dev route. The landing-page profile portrait remained a visual identity element rather than a direct navigation affordance, and the main nav did not have About Dev active-state behavior.
- The user wanted three mockups for an About Dev page suitable for a full-stack developer, then selected the Builder Story direction for implementation under the file and route name aboutdev.
- The first About Dev build needed repeated profile-bubble tuning. The original page portrait was too large, the available image set did not include a transparent-background cutout, and the final direction was to use the same circular landing portrait bubble and name-tag relationship instead of a new image treatment.
- During narrow and portrait restacking, the profile bubble was snapping smaller than intended and needed to stay at the same 282px rendered size while staying horizontally centered under the hero copy.
- The top navigation on About Dev initially sat too close to the viewport edge compared with other pages, so the page needed the same persistent small vertical gap above the nav.
- The initial Core Beliefs section used rectangular cards and draft software-principle language. The user supplied exact replacement copy, renamed headings, reordered the cards, removed the Readiness card, and then requested circular proof cards arranged around a star centerpiece.
- The landing Featured Case Studies cards already showed platform and device labels, but there was no horizontal divider between PLATFORM and DEVICE, and the card proof stats and landing proof-stack worklog count needed final updates.

Goals for September 15

- Create three visual mockups for a full-stack developer About Dev page and implement the selected 02 Builder Story direction at /aboutdev.
- Wire click and tap on the landing-page profile photo so it navigates to the new About Dev page while preserving the existing portrait, tag, hover, and focus identity treatment.
- Keep the work local during the page implementation unless explicitly told otherwise, including no production publish from this session.
- Match the About Dev profile bubble to the round landing portrait treatment, scale it to the accepted fixed size, keep the name tag proportional, prevent narrow-viewport shrinking, and center it during restacked hero layouts.
- Bring the About Dev navbar spacing into line with the other pages by keeping a small vertical gap above the top nav rather than snapping the nav to the viewport edge.
- Replace draft Core Beliefs language with the user supplied headings and exact text snippets, then rework the section into five circular cards around a black-and-green stroke-only star for wide and medium-wide layouts.
- On really narrow views, switch the Core Beliefs formation to one circular card at a time, horizontally centered, with the decorative star hidden only in that narrow fallback.
- Update Featured Case Studies card quantities, raise the landing worklog proof stat to 0.2k, and add a thin measured horizontal divider between PLATFORM and DEVICE rows that extends symmetrically across the right-side platform/device column area.

- Clear local development cache when requested, verify responsive behavior in browser where layout precision matters, run TypeScript and static-export checks, restore generated Next.js route metadata, refresh the snapshot, and document the final committed source accurately.

Work Completed - About Dev Mockups and Route

- Created a three-option About Dev mockup board covering Systems Proof, Builder Story, and Operating Manual directions, then preserved the selected Builder Story option as the implementation reference.
- Added `app/aboutdev/page.tsx` with route metadata, a hero narrative, proof chips, a profile figure, an evidence-based timeline, a working-style quote band, My Core Beliefs, and a case-study/contact CTA block.
- Built the page around full-stack developer proof instead of biography filler: design systems, native commerce, API contracts, release notes, documentation, shipped mobile products, payment rails, and inspectable process artifacts.
- Imported the shared `MainNavBar` with `context="aboutdev"` so the About Dev page uses the same navigation component as the rest of the portfolio while marking the About Dev item as the active local context.
- Wired the landing hero profile photo in `app/page.tsx` to `href="/aboutdev"` with an accessible `aria-label`, preserving the visible portrait and Martin Prahls name tag while turning the image into a real click/tap target.
- Added hover and focus-visible styling for the profile photo link in `app/globals.css` so the new interaction has keyboard-visible affordance without changing the accepted landing-page portrait composition.
- Kept About Dev as a local route during implementation. The page was added to the source tree and later validated through the static route list, but no production deployment or Hostinger publish was performed by the PDF-generation pass.

Work Completed - Profile Bubble, Nav, and Responsive Layout

- Replaced the first About Dev profile treatment with the exact round portrait image bubble language used on the landing page, using `/images/martin3.jpg` and the same circular profile-photo class lineage.
- Confirmed there was no transparent-background profile cutout in the active image set during the profile-image review, then followed the user direction to use the landing portrait bubble replica instead.
- Reduced the earlier oversized About Dev portrait and settled the page profile bubble at a fixed 282px square, with the photo explicitly held at 282px by 282px and `max-width` disabled so narrow viewports cannot shrink it unexpectedly.
- Added the Martin Prahls tag under the About Dev portrait and scaled the tag with the same name-tag-to-bubble relationship used by the landing hero, including the dark translucent badge, mint text, rounded 8px corners, and centered text alignment.
- Kept the bubble unchanged during wide widths and applied restacked positioning only when the hero becomes one column, so the portrait moves under the hero text without disturbing the accepted wide composition.
- Centered the bubble horizontally in restacked portrait and narrow layouts and used the final narrow override to preserve the 282px bubble size even at very narrow aspect ratios.
- Adjusted the restacked vertical placement so the portrait sits between the top proof-chip stack and the bottom of the darker hero overlay gradient, matching the user intent for the hero after the layout collapses.
- Added page-level top padding for `.aboutdev-page` so the top navigation keeps a small vertical gap above it, matching the look of the other pages instead of snapping to the viewport top edge.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Circular Formation

- Changed the section heading from the mockup label to My Core Beliefs and replaced the draft cards with the five user-approved concepts: Vision, Modernness, Inter-connectedness, User-friendliness, and Cohesion.

- Removed the Readiness card completely, including the one-stop-shop 2027 copy, leaving five belief cards instead of six.
- Implemented the final Vision text: Without imagination, there is no working prototype, and without a working prototype, well... There is no front-end, back-end, or final build.
- Implemented the final Inter-connectedness text: Breaking down barriers between art and science, design and code, isn't some arbitrary nicety; It's the guiding principle behind everything I do.
- Implemented the User-friendliness, Cohesion, and Modernness text supplied during the copy pass, preserving the requested capitalization, punctuation, and emphasis style as source content.
- Reordered the cards to Vision, Modernness, Inter-connectedness, User-friendliness, and Cohesion, then gave Modernness and Cohesion distinct accent colors so the five-circle system does not read as repeated variants of one heading color.
- Created the circular proof-card mockup and the star-center mockup under mockups/ before implementation, using those approved visual studies to restore the symmetric formation the user preferred.
- Replaced the rectangular grid with a positioned circular formation: one circle at top center, two on the upper sides, two on the lower sides, and a centered star in the open middle.
- Converted the center star to a purely visual element with no text, removed the brighter inner star, removed fill completely, and reduced the green stroke width through the requested half and additional 25 percent passes.
- Matched the belief-card heading and description font sizes to the existing About Dev card language, including the working-style card scale used by Precise, visual, and persistent.
- Set Inter-connectedness to wrap like User-friendliness and corrected horizontal text centering inside the circle during resizing by keeping the heading width content-based and centered with margin-inline auto.
- Kept the circular star formation intact across wide and medium-wide windows, allowing the formation to resize as one system instead of splitting into separate wide and medium layouts.
- Limited the one-by-one vertical fallback to the extreme narrow breakpoint, where the five circles stack vertically and the decorative star is hidden. The star remains present for wide and medium-wide formations.

Work Completed - Landing Case Study Proof Details

- Updated the Featured Case Studies header quantities from the remote-repository reference pass, leaving the current card values as Cinerific 66 commits and 20 worklogs, Alla Vostra 384 commits and 65 worklogs, Credit King 82 commits and 0 worklogs, and Prahlin.dev 110 commits and 37 worklogs.
- Updated the landing hero proof stat from 0.1k Real-Time Project Worklogs to 0.2k Real-Time Project Worklogs in app/page.tsx.
- Added a dedicated measured row-divider element to ProjectDeviceStack when platform labels and device labels are both present. The web-only portfolio card omits the divider because it has no DEVICE row.
- Measured PLATFORM and DEVICE heading rectangles and all platform/device vertical divider centers with getBoundingClientRect inside a useLayoutEffect, then wrote CSS custom properties for divider left, top, and width.
- Placed the divider at the exact vertical midpoint between the PLATFORM and DEVICE row centers, as requested, instead of approximating it with fixed CSS percentages.
- Set the line to begin at the horizontal center of the DEVICE heading and extend rightward through the platform/device column space, with matching overhang past the rightmost vertical divider and the leftmost divider.
- Doubled the vertical breathing room around the divider by increasing the platform-label list row gap to 12px, which separated PLATFORM and DEVICE while keeping the new hairline visually distinct.
- Matched the Cinerific line length to Alla Vostra and Credit King by basing the right overhang on the measured difference between the DEVICE center and the leftmost vertical divider, producing symmetric extension on both sides.

- Styled the divider as a thinner-than-existing card line: a 1px mint-green line visually compressed with `scaleY(0.65)`, subtle glow, pointer-events disabled, and opacity gated by `data-platform-row-divider-ready`.

Work Completed - Cache, Validation, and Commit Context

- Cleared generated local development cache during the responsive profile and card-divider session, including `.next` cache paths, then continued with local-only verification rather than public deployment.
- Used browser-driven checks during the implementation pass to inspect About Dev profile sizing, restacked portrait centering, circular belief formation behavior, star centering, and the Featured Case Studies divider geometry.
- Verified the case-card divider overhang behavior across Cinerific, Alla Vostra, and Credit King at wide, medium, and phone widths, including matching left and right overhangs for the visible platform/device line.
- Provided multiple requested commit-message drafts during the source session and captured the final work in the three September 15 commits now present on main.
- Ran `npm run check` during this documentation pass; TypeScript completed successfully with `tsc --noEmit`.
- Ran `npm run build:static` during this documentation pass; Next.js 16.2.10 compiled, type-checked, collected page data, and generated seven static pages successfully.
- Confirmed the static export route list included `/`, `/aboutdev`, `/articles`, `/projects/alla-vostra`, and `/projects/cinerific`, proving the new About Dev route participates in the static build.
- Restored `next-env.d.ts` from the generated static-build route reference back to the repository convention import `"./next/dev/types/routes.d.ts"` after `npm run build:static` rewrote it.
- Reviewed git status after validation. Before PDF generation, the only tracked delta was the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` file; `next-env.d.ts` had no remaining diff.

Validation Summary

- `npm run check` passed with `tsc --noEmit`.
- `npm run build:static` passed with `NEXT_OUTPUT=export` next build and generated all expected static routes, including the new `/aboutdev` page.
- The static-build side effect in `next-env.d.ts` was corrected before the PDF was generated, leaving the dev-route import restored and no tracked `next-env.d.ts` diff.
- The About Dev source now renders a single-page route with hero, profile bubble, timeline, working-style card, circular core beliefs, and CTA sections, all using the shared site shell and nav component.
- The Core Beliefs formation keeps the center star for wide and medium-wide layouts, switches to centered one-by-one circles only at the very narrow breakpoint, and hides the decorative star only in that narrow fallback.
- The landing profile photo now exposes a real `/aboutdev` link with accessible labeling and visible hover/focus treatment while retaining the landing portrait and Martin Prahl tag composition.
- The Featured Case Studies platform/device divider is calculated from live DOM geometry, so the line stays aligned to the actual PLATFORM and DEVICE rows and to the right-side vertical divider system across responsive widths.
- `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` was regenerated before this PDF so the companion source snapshot records current source state, recent commit history, and the pre-existing PDF worklog inventory.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- `app/aboutdev/page.tsx` - added the About Dev route and later refined its profile bubble, timeline, working-style copy, My Core Beliefs content, circular-card data, and CTA structure.
- `app/globals.css` - added About Dev layout, profile bubble, navigation gap, timeline, quote card, CTA, circular principles formation, narrow stacked fallback, landing profile-link affordances, and case-card divider styling.

- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - added About Dev nav behavior and updated Featured Case Studies commit and worklog quantities.
- app/page.tsx - wired the landing profile image to /aboutdev and updated the Real-Time Project Worklogs proof value to 0.2k.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - added measured platform/device row-divider logic for case-study card platform-label stacks.
- mockups/about-dev-page-mockups.html and the About Dev option PNG files - documented the three candidate About Dev directions and the selected Builder Story visual exploration.
- mockups/about-dev-core-beliefs-circular-mockup.html/png and mockups/about-dev-core-beliefs-star-mockup.html/png - documented the approved circular belief-card and star-center studies before implementation.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed through ./read_project.sh for this documentation pass after the September 15 source commits.
- portfolio_worklog_september15.pdf - generated as this new root-level dated Portfolio documentation artifact.

Follow-Up Context

- The About Dev page is now a real route at /aboutdev, and the landing profile photo intentionally opens it. Future edits to profile-photo behavior should preserve the image link, aria-label, hover state, and focus-visible state.
- The About Dev profile bubble intentionally stays fixed at 282px in narrow and portrait restacking. Avoid max-width or percentage overrides that let the portrait shrink below the accepted size.
- The Core Beliefs star has no fill and no text by design. It is a decorative centerpiece only, with the five circular cards carrying all copy.
- The narrow Core Beliefs fallback is intentionally reserved for the very narrow breakpoint. Medium-wide windows should continue to show the same star formation resized as one visual system.
- The current belief-card labels are Vision, Modernness, Inter-connectedness, User-friendliness, and Cohesion. Readiness was intentionally removed and should not be restored without a new user request.
- The Featured Case Studies horizontal divider depends on runtime measurement of headings and vertical dividers. Future markup changes to the platform/device grid should keep data-platform-row-divider-ready and the CSS custom property contract in mind.
- The landing worklog proof now reads 0.2k Real-Time Project Worklogs. Future proof-stat changes should consider both visible text and any responsive sizing behavior shared through ProofStats.
- The project remains on the established Portfolio workflow: local implementation and verification first, with public deployment or Hostinger synchronization only when the user explicitly asks for it.

Output Artifact

- Generated: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_september15.pdf
- Companion sync file: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt
- Source state reviewed: 076def6c932e852b6372c5043a302790aacf536a on main.
- Naming follows the established first-worklog-on-date convention: portfolio_worklog_september15.pdf. No Part suffix was used because no earlier September 15 Portfolio worklog PDF existed.
- The document records the About Dev mockup and implementation pass, landing profile navigation, responsive profile-bubble refinements, My Core Beliefs circular formation, Featured Case Studies stats and divider work, local cache clearing, validation, committed source context, refreshed snapshot, and documentation work in the established Prahlin Portfolio format.
- This worklog closes the September 15 documentation pass. No source commit, push, deployment, public publish, or Hostinger synchronization was performed as part of generating the PDF.